TEAM AYILAVAN · PRODUCT STRATEGY

Gamification Strategy

An Octalysis-framework plan for daily engagement — Thiruppugazh app

Status: Proposal, not yet implemented **Drafted:** 2026-09-22 **Against:** v1.3.0

0. The one-sentence thesis

> **Do not import Duolingo into a devotional app. Digitise the vow.**

Tamil Murugan devotion already contains, natively, every mechanic the Octalysis Framework describes — and those mechanics carry centuries of legitimacy that a points system never will. Our job is not to invent a game layer. It is to recognise the game that is already there and give it a screen.

The design rule that follows: every mechanic we ship must have a name a devotee would recognise. If we cannot name it in Tamil devotional vocabulary, we do not ship it.

Generic gamification	What we ship instead
"7-day streak 🔥"	**விரதம் / நோன்பு** — a kept vow
XP bar to next level	**பாராயணம்** — sequential completion of the corpus
Badge collection	**அறுபடை வீடு** — the six abodes
Daily login bonus	**The festival calendar** — Sashti, Karthigai, Thai Poosam
"Daily mission"	**சங்கல்பம்** — a stated intention
Points	**Japa count** — 108
Global leaderboard	**Group parayanam** — a family completing the corpus together
Mystery box / loot	**அருள்** — the verse that finds you

1. What we are working with

Pulled from `assets/thiruppugazh.db` and the current codebase, because a strategy has to be buildable on what actually exists.

Asset	Number	Strategic use
Songs	**1,334**	The corpus. At one a day = 3.6 years. This is an *endgame-length* arc.
Temples	**214**	A ready-made exploration map
Temples with exactly 1 song	**118**	Genuinely rare finds — scarcity we don't have to invent
The six abodes (Arupadai Veedu)	**316 songs**	Palani 98 · Thiruchendur 84 · Thiruthani 64 · Swamimalai 40 · Pazhamudircholai 16 · Thirupparankundram 14
`common` (non-temple-specific)	315 songs	The "everyday" pool
Distinct thālam patterns	**1,005**	A second, completely unexploited axis of exploration
Median lyric lines per song	**16**	A song is a 2–4 minute reading. The daily loop fits in a coffee break.
Songs with English content	1,327 / 1,334	Reaches diaspora and non-Tamil readers

All six Arupadai Veedu abodes are already in the data. The single most culturally loaded collection set in Murugan devotion is buildable today with zero new content.

Constraints that shape everything

From the project charter (`README.md`) — these are **features, not obstacles**:

- **No tracking.** No analytics, no telemetry.
- **Offline first.** No server, no account, no sync.
- **No ads.**
- Open source, AGPL-3.0.

This rules out real leaderboards, friend graphs, social feeds, and server-verified achievements. Which is a gift: it forces the design White Hat and intrinsic. We could not build a Skinner box here even if we wanted to.

Technical starting point

- 5 bottom tabs (`lib/ui/screens/main_wrapper.dart:152`) — Home, Temples, Categories, Library, Settings

- DB at **v3**; migration hook already in `lib/data/database/database_helper.dart`
- Existing user-data tables: `categories`, `song_categories`, `highlights`, `notes`, `songs.is_favorite`
- `shared_preferences`, `share_plus`, `file_picker`, `BackupService` all present
- **No notification dependency. No audio dependency.** The first is a real gap (§7); the second is out of scope for this document.

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2. Octalysis audit — the app as it stands today

Scored 0–10 on each Core Drive, for shipped v1.3.0.

#	Core Drive	Today	Evidence
1	**Epic Meaning & Calling**	**3**	The *content* is pure epic meaning — Arunagirinathar, Murugan, "Muruga Saranam", free and open forever. But the app never **tells** the user they are part of anything. No narrative, no calling, no custodianship.
2	**Development & Accomplishment**	**0**	Nothing. A user cannot answer "how much of this have I read?" There is no progress anywhere in the app.
3	**Empowerment of Creativity & Feedback**	**4**	Highlights, notes, custom categories, font size, dual language toggles — genuine creative agency. But it is **write-only**: the app never responds to what you make.
4	**Ownership & Possession**	**5**	Favourites, categories, highlights, notes, backup/export. The app's one working drive. But nothing visibly *accrues*.
5	**Social Influence & Relatedness**	**2**	Deep-link sharing only. No group, no mentorship, no sense that anyone else exists.
6	**Scarcity & Impatience**	**0**	Everything available at once, forever. 1,334 songs, no pacing, no calendar.
7	**Unpredictability & Curiosity**	**3**	The random-song shuffle FAB is the single spark. Nothing else ever surprises.
8	**Loss & Avoidance**	**0**	Nothing to lose. *(And for this app that is mostly correct — see §6.8.)*
	Total	**17 / 80**	

Diagnosis

The app is a **reference work**. A reference work gets opened when you need something. A **practice** gets opened every day. The entire distance between those two things is Drive 2 (nothing at all), Drive 7 (one FAB), and Drive 1 (present in the content, absent from the product).

Drive 4 is already good. Drive 3 is half-built and cheap to finish. That is the wedge.

Target after the roadmap in §8

Drive	Today	Target	Brain	Hat
1 Epic Meaning	3	**7**	—	White
2 Accomplishment	0	**7**	Left	White
3 Empowerment	4	**7**	Right	White
4 Ownership	5	**8**	Left	White
5 Social	2	**5**	Right	Neutral
6 Scarcity	0	**3**	Left	Black
7 Curiosity	3	**6**	Right	Black
8 Loss	0	**3**	—	Black
	17	**46**		

Deliberately **White-Hat heavy, Black-Hat light** — drives 6/7/8 sum to 12 of 46. That is the correct shape for a devotional app: sustainable daily practice, never compulsion. An app that makes someone feel *obligated* to pray has failed at the thing it was built for.

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3. The Daily Loop — the actual "come back every day" design

Everything else in this document exists to support this one screen. Target: **under 4 minutes**, completable before the user puts the phone down.

```
OPEN APP
  │
  ├─ 1. Greeting + calendar context                                  ~1 sec
  │     "செவ்வாய் · கார்த்திகை நட்சத்திரம் in 4 days"
  │     Drive 1 (you are inside a living tradition) + Drive 6 (a real appointment)
  │
  ├─ 2. இன்றைய அருள் — Today's verse                                 ~30 sec
  │     ONE verse. Tamil + meaning. Seeded by date, so every user in the
  │     world sees the same verse today.
  │     Drive 7 (what will it be?) + Drive 5 (a shared object, with no server)
  │
  ├─ 3. இன்றைய பாடல் — Today's hymn                                   2–3 min
  │     The next song in your active parayanam. If none, a suggestion.
  │     Reading it IS the day's completion.
  │     Drive 2 (the count moves) + Drive 4 (the corpus fills in)
  │
  ├─ 4. நிறைவு — Quiet acknowledgment                                 ~2 sec
  │     Not a fanfare. Not confetti. A mark. "இன்று நிறைவு."
  │     Total days kept ticks up.
  │     Drive 2, with restraint
  │
  └─ 5. Optional depth — note, highlight, word meanings
        Never required. Never nagged.
        Drive 3
```

The completion rule (non-negotiable)

A song counts as read when **either**:

- the detail screen was scrolled to the final verse, **or**
- the detail screen was foregrounded on that song for ≥ 90 seconds.

Never on tap. Never on open. If the number can be farmed, the number is worthless — and the user will know it is worthless, which destroys Drive 2 entirely. The integrity of the count *is* the product.

The notification

- **One per day. Maximum.** At a time the user chose.

- **Default OFF.** Asked for on **day 3 of self-directed use** — never at install.
- The content is **the verse itself**, not a nag: `இன்றைய அருள் – "<first line>"`
- A user who never opens the app has still received prasādam. The notification has value even when it does not convert. That is the test for whether a notification is service or spam.
- **Forbidden:** "Murugan is waiting." "Don't lose your streak." "You haven't read today." Any notification that makes someone feel guilty about their own devotion is a failure.

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4. The Four Phases of the Player Journey

Phase 1 — Discovery (why would I install this?)

The Play listing currently leads with features. Lead with the practice:

> Read all 1,334 Thiruppugazh hymns. A daily practice, not just a library. No ads. No account. No tracking. Works fully offline.

The privacy charter is a genuine differentiator in a category full of ad-stuffed devotional apps — it should be the second line, not buried.

Organic acquisition channel: shareable verse cards (§6.5). Devotees already forward verses on WhatsApp every morning. A beautiful card carrying a link is how this app spreads — not a referral programme.

Phase 2 — Onboarding (first 5 minutes)

1. **சங்கல்பம் — the intention.** "Why are you here?"
   - தினசரி பாராயணம் — a daily practice
   - பொருள் அறிய — to understand the meanings
   - கோயில் தொடர்பு — temple by temple
   - சும்மா பார்க்க — just looking

   This is a *Glowing Choice* (Drive 3) and it sets the default daily loop. "Just looking" is a real, respected answer — it turns the daily card off and leaves a clean library.
2. **Deliver value before asking for anything.** One verse and its meaning, immediately.
3. **Beginner's Luck** (Drive 2): the first song completes easily; the first milestone (6) is reachable inside a week.
4. **Do not show 1,334 as a wall.** Frame it as heritage, not backlog:

   > "Arunagirinathar composed over 16,000 hymns. 1,334 survived. You are one of the people keeping them read."

5. **Set the daily time.** Do **not** ask for notification permission yet.

Phase 3 — Scaffolding (day 2 → day 100)

This is where every app dies. The daily loop (§3) is the entire scaffold. Variety comes from four inexhaustible sources we already own:

- **214 temples** — "a hymn from a temple you've never opened"

- **1,005 thālam patterns** — rhythm-based exploration, completely untapped today
- **The festival calendar** — Sashti, Thai Poosam, Karthigai, Vaikasi Visakam, monthly Karthigai nakshatram, every Tuesday
- **Your own growing highlights** — the app reflecting your past practice back at you

Milestones with Tamil weight, not arbitrary levels:

Count	Why this number
6	Sashti · the six abodes · reachable in a week
21	A standard mandala vow length
48	**மண்டலம்** — the canonical 48-day practice unit
108	*The* number. Reaching it should feel like an event.
216	108 × 2
540	108 × 5
1,008	The great count
1,334	The whole corpus

Day 48 — first mandalam completion — is the retention checkpoint that matters. Design a genuine ceremony for it: a full-screen moment, a permanent record, an optional completion card. A user who reaches day 48 will reach day 400.

Phase 4 — Endgame (the 1,334th hymn, and after)

Most gamification designs have nothing here. At one hymn a day this is 3.6 years away — which is *exactly* why it must exist, because it defines what the whole arc is for.

- **Second parayanam.** Traditional practice is *repeated*, not completed-once. On finishing, the count continues: "2nd parayanam · 40 / 1334." This is the correct answer and it is the culturally native one.
- **Depth instead of breadth.** The loop shifts emphasis to meanings, to the word-by-word `patham` breakdown (already in the DB), to thālam study.
- **Custodianship.** The endgame user becomes a **corrector** and a **curator** — reporting text errors, and exporting mandalam sequences that guide beginners (§6.5).

Note that the endgame is carried by **Drive 1 and Drive 5** — meaning and mentorship. That is exactly right. Nobody sustains a decade of practice on a progress bar.

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5. Ethical guardrails

This section is not decoration. Gamifying religious practice can do real harm, and a devotee who feels manipulated by a prayer app does not churn quietly — they feel betrayed.

The review question for every proposed mechanic:

> *Would a devotee describe this as helping their practice — or as the app playing with them?*

Six rules, non-negotiable:

1. **Never gate a hymn.** All 1,334 stay free, offline, and open. Forever. No content is ever locked behind progress, payment, or a streak.
2. **Never shame a missed day.** No red, no "you lost it", no extinguished flame, no guilt.
3. **No leaderboards of devotion.** We will not rank human beings by piety. Not globally, not among friends, not ever.
4. **No invented currency.** Hymns read is the only number. Inventing XP on top of a sacred corpus is the fastest possible way to make this app feel cheap.
5. **Completion must be earned by actual reading** (§3), or the number is meaningless.
6. **Every number stays on the device.** If a feature cannot be built without a server, we do not build the feature.
7. **The whole layer is optional.** A single Settings toggle — *தினசரி பயிற்சி / Daily practice* — removes the daily card, all counts, all collections and all notifications, returning the app to exactly the v1.3.0 experience. Choosing "சும்மா பார்க்க / just looking" at onboarding sets it off from the start. **The README promises a simple, purposeful app; for the user who wants a plain library, that promise must remain literally true.** This is a hard requirement of v1.4, not a later addition — it ships in the same release as the daily card or the daily card does not ship.

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6. The eight drives → concrete features

6.1 — Epic Meaning & Calling *(3 → 7)*

- **Rightful Heritage framing.** "16,000 composed. 1,334 survived. You are a custodian." Reframes the library from a thing you consume into a thing you keep alive.
- **Report a correction.** Long-press a verse → "report a correction" → opens a GitHub issue or queues an export. Devotees become co-custodians of the text. *Ship this early:* `docs/database.md` already records that **song 1328** has its lyrics sitting in the `tune` column. That class of bug should be found by ten thousand devotees, not by us proof-reading 1,334 songs.
- **The covenant.** Surface the no-ads / no-tracking / no-account promise **once**, at onboarding, as a commitment — not as a bullet list of features.
- **Sankalpam** (§4, Phase 2) — the practice begins with a stated intention, as it should.

6.2 — Development & Accomplishment *(0 → 7)*

- **Parayanam progress** as the app's primary number: `நீங்கள் படித்தவை – 47 / 1334`.
- **Mandalam arcs (48 days)** — a culturally standard, visibly finishable unit. Not "Level 34".
- **Milestones at 6 / 21 / 48 / 108 / 216 / 540 / 1008 / 1334** (§4).
- **Per-temple progress** — "பழநி · 12 / 98". This turns the *existing* Temples tab into a progress map for almost no work.
- **No points. No XP. No levels.** (Guardrail 4.)

6.3 — Empowerment of Creativity & Feedback *(4 → 7)*

The app's biggest cheap win: highlights, notes and categories exist but are **write-only**.

- **Make the Library tab answer back.** "You've highlighted 14 verses that mention ஞானம்." Surface themes across the user's own highlights. Evergreen — it never runs out, and it gets better the more they use it.
- **Today's verse drawn from your own highlights**, once you have ≥ 10. The app reflecting your past practice back at you is the strongest retention mechanic available, and it requires zero tracking and zero new content.
- **Build-your-own parayanam.** Categories already exist — let one be marked an *ordered recitation set* with a position pointer. "My morning 9." Resume where you left off.
- **Chain combo — முழுமை.** Read + note + highlight in one sitting earns a small visual acknowledgment. An acknowledgment, not a reward.

6.4 — Ownership & Possession *(5 → 8)*

- 🏆 **Arupadai Veedu — the flagship collection.** Six panels, 316 songs, filling in as you read. Every Tamil devotee already knows this pilgrimage, so completing it in-app reads as a digital yātra rather than

badge-collecting. **This is the single highest-value feature in this document** — maximum cultural resonance, zero new content, data already present.

- **The temple map.** 214 temples; **118 have exactly one song**. Those singletons are genuinely rare finds — real scarcity, nothing manufactured.
- **Your personal thirumurai.** Highlights + notes + categories + progress rendered as one beautiful, exportable document (Markdown / PDF). `BackupService` is the mechanical version of this; this is the emotional one. High attachment — and ethically clean, because the asset is genuinely yours and genuinely portable.
- **Alfred effect.** The app already remembers font size, theme, and both language settings. Extend to last verse position and preferred reading time.

6.5 — Social Influence & Relatedness *(2 → 5)*

No accounts, no server. So: **artifact-based social, not network-based social.**

- **Share the verse, not the score.** Sharing produces a beautiful verse card (Tamil typography, temple name, app link). **Never** "I read 47 songs!" Devotees forward scripture; they do not forward statistics. This is Touting done with dignity — and it is the app's main organic growth channel.
- 🏆 **Group Parayanam, no server.** A family or temple group splits the corpus (1,334 ÷ 12 people ≈ 112 each). Each phone tracks its own slice. Progress is shared by exporting a short code string, pasted into WhatsApp; any member's app imports it and renders a combined progress wheel. **Zero backend, zero accounts, a real Group Quest** — and fully compatible with the charter.
- **Mentorship.** An experienced devotee exports a curated 48-day mandalam sequence as a file or link; a beginner imports it. Content passed between devotees — not a follower graph.
- **Water cooler.** The GitHub link is already in Settings; point it at Discussions.

6.6 — Scarcity & Impatience *(0 → 3)* ⚠️ Black Hat — use sparingly

Manufactured scarcity in a devotional app is corrosive. But there is **real** scarcity available that we do not have to invent:

- **The calendar is genuinely scarce.** Skanda Sashti: once a year. Thai Poosam: once a year. Karthigai nakshatram: once a month. Tuesdays: weekly. These appointment dynamics exist whether or not we build the app. Surfacing them is **service**, not manipulation.
- **The Sashti six-day arc** — a real, bounded, once-a-year vow with a defined song set. The best annual engagement event available to us, and it is culturally authentic.
- **Never** gate content. **Never** throttle. **Never** put a countdown timer on a hymn.

6.7 — Unpredictability & Curiosity *(3 → 6)*

The existing shuffle FAB is the seed of all of this.

- **அருள் — the verse that finds you.** Deterministic per day (seed = date), so the whole community receives the same verse. Framed as prasādam, not as a random number generator. The shared daily verse creates a social object with **no server at all** — everyone who opens the app today can discuss the same verse.

- **The Oracle.** The existing shuffle, reframed: hold a question in mind, tap, receive a verse. A recognised practice. **Zero new code** — it is a copy change on a shipped feature.
- **Easter eggs.** On Sashti, on Thai Poosam, on your own 108th hymn — the app quietly changes its appearance. Unannounced. Found, not advertised.
- **Mini-quests.** "Today: a hymn from a temple you've never opened." One line, one tap, endlessly generative from a 214-row table.

6.8 — Loss & Avoidance *(0 → 3)* ⚠️ ⚠️ Most restricted drive

The most dangerous drive in this context, and the one most likely to be misused by a well-meaning implementer.

- **Kept days, not unbroken streaks.** Track **total days practiced** (never resets) *and* current continuity (resets **quietly**, with no ceremony and no colour change). The permanent number is the one displayed large. A year of practice is not erased by a fever.
- **Grace is built in.** Viratham traditions already include prāyaścitta — make-up practice. A missed day offers a make-up reading. It does not scold.
- **The one legitimate FOMO:** "Sashti begins in 3 days." That is a calendar fact.
- **Sunk cost is acceptable when the asset is real.** Notes and highlights genuinely accumulate and are genuinely exportable. Attachment to real, portable property is not a dark pattern.

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7. Data model — proposed v4 migration

```sql
-- Schema v4: practice tracking. All local. Never leaves the device.

CREATE TABLE reading_log (
  id            INTEGER PRIMARY KEY AUTOINCREMENT,
  song_id       INTEGER NOT NULL REFERENCES songs(id) ON DELETE CASCADE,
  read_on       TEXT    NOT NULL,              -- ISO date, local tz
  dwell_seconds INTEGER NOT NULL,
  completed     INTEGER NOT NULL DEFAULT 0,    -- per the §3 completion rule
  UNIQUE(song_id, read_on)
);
CREATE INDEX idx_reading_log_read_on ON reading_log(read_on);
CREATE INDEX idx_reading_log_song_id ON reading_log(song_id);

-- Denormalised from reading_log so the home screen never scans.
CREATE TABLE practice_days (
  day             TEXT PRIMARY KEY,            -- ISO date
  songs_completed INTEGER NOT NULL DEFAULT 0,
  verse_seen      INTEGER NOT NULL DEFAULT 0
);

CREATE TABLE parayanam (
  id          INTEGER PRIMARY KEY AUTOINCREMENT,
  name        TEXT    NOT NULL,
  source_type TEXT    NOT NULL,                -- 'all' | 'temple' | 'category' | 'custom'
  source_key  TEXT,                            -- temple name, or category id
  cursor      INTEGER NOT NULL DEFAULT 0,      -- position in the ordered set
  cycle       INTEGER NOT NULL DEFAULT 1,      -- 2nd parayanam, 3rd, ... (endgame)
  started_on  TEXT    NOT NULL,
  is_active   INTEGER NOT NULL DEFAULT 0
);

CREATE TABLE milestones (
  key         TEXT PRIMARY KEY,                -- 'songs_108', 'arupadai_pazhani', 'mandalam_1'
  achieved_on TEXT NOT NULL
);

-- Ordered recitation sets (§6.3)
ALTER TABLE song_categories ADD COLUMN position INTEGER;
ALTER TABLE categories      ADD COLUMN is_sequence INTEGER NOT NULL DEFAULT 0;
```

Derived values (no extra storage)

- **Total days kept** — `SELECT COUNT(*) FROM practice_days`
- **Current continuity** — walk `practice_days` backwards from today
- **Corpus progress** — `SELECT COUNT(DISTINCT song_id) FROM reading_log WHERE completed = 1`
- **Per-temple progress** — join `reading_log` → `songs.place`

⚠️ Backup becomes critical

`BackupService` **must** be extended to cover these tables in the same release that adds them. A reinstall that silently wipes three years of practice is the one place in this design where loss would be real, and it would be unforgivable.

New dependencies

Package	For	Phase
`flutter_local_notifications`	The daily verse notification	v1.5
`timezone`	Correct local scheduling across DST and travel	v1.5

Neither exists in `pubspec.yaml` today.

⚠️ **The notification permission needs care.** On Android 13+ (API 33) this requires `POST_NOTIFICATIONS`, a runtime permission — in an app that advertises "no tracking", a permission prompt can read as a broken promise if it arrives cold. Mitigations:

- Ask on **day 3**, in-context, immediately after showing what the notification will contain.
- Precede the system prompt with our own screen explaining that the notification is generated **on the device**, from the bundled database, and that nothing is sent or received.
- The app must remain fully functional on denial. Notifications are a convenience, never a gate.
- Notifications are **local-only** and do not change the Play Data Safety declaration (no data collected, no data shared). Confirm this when filing the v1.5 release.

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8. Roadmap

v1.4 — "The Daily Loop"

The minimum that changes what kind of app this is.

- DB v4: `reading_log`, `practice_days` + backup coverage
- Home screen daily card: date, festival context, today's verse (date-seeded), today's hymn
- Dwell-based completion (§3) + **total days kept**
- Corpus progress `n / 1334`
- **No notifications yet.** Prove the loop works when people come on their own. If it only works when we ping them, it does not work.

v1.5 — "Vow & Abode"

- `flutter_local_notifications` + `timezone`; daily verse notification, opt-in, default off, asked on day 3
- 🏆 **Arupadai Veedu six-panel collection screen**
- Per-temple progress in the existing Temples tab
- Milestones 6 / 21 / 48 / 108 with Tamil framing, plus the day-48 mandalam ceremony
- Festival calendar: Sashti, Thai Poosam, Karthigai, Vaikasi Visakam, monthly Karthigai, Tuesdays

v1.6 — "Your Thirumurai"

- Ordered parayanam sets from categories, with resume
- Library tab reflections — your own highlights, surfaced back at you
- Exportable personal thirumurai (Markdown / PDF)
- "Report a correction" → GitHub issue / export

v2.0 — "Together"

- 🏆 **Group parayanam** via pasteable code, no server
- Shareable verse cards (image)
- Importable curated mandalams (mentorship)
- Endgame: second parayanam + depth mode

Where this goes in the UI

The daily card belongs at the **top of Home**, above the song list — not in a sixth tab. Six bottom tabs is too many, and burying the daily loop in a tab guarantees it is never seen. The progress and collection surfaces (Arupadai Veedu, milestones, stats) belong inside the **Library** tab, which is currently the least-loaded and most conceptually appropriate home for them.

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9. Measuring this without tracking anyone

We collect nothing. That is the charter. So measurement has to be honest about its limits:

1. **The user's own stats screen is the mirror.** They see it. We do not. That is the deal.
2. ⚠️ **Recommendation: do NOT add opt-in telemetry.** An earlier draft of this document proposed a one-shot, opt-in, fully-disclosed "help improve the app" upload. On review, **reject it**:
   - It would change the app's **Play Data Safety declaration** from "no data collected" to "app activity collected" — the single strongest line in our store listing — for a trickle of self-selected, unrepresentative data.
   - "No tracking" is a promise that survives exactly as long as it has no asterisk. An opt-in exception is still an asterisk, and it is the one competitors' listings cannot match.
   - The proxies in point 3 answer the only question that actually matters.

   If the team ever revisits this, it needs a deliberate decision on the record — not a quiet addition inside a feature release.
3. **Proxies we already have, for free:**
   - Play Console retention (D1 / D7 / **D30**)
   - Uninstall rate
   - Review text — the richest qualitative signal available to us
   - GitHub issue and Discussion volume
4. **Pre-register the targets now**, before building, so we cannot rationalise whatever happens afterwards. Fill in the baselines from Play Console:

Metric	Baseline	Target after v1.5
D30 retention	*(fill from Play Console)*	*(set before shipping)*
Median days kept per active user per month	n/a	≥ 12
Actives with an active parayanam	n/a	≥ 30% by v1.6
Day-48 mandalam completions	n/a	*(set before shipping)*

D30 retention is the single number that says whether the loop works.

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10. Anti-patterns — what we will be tempted by, and will refuse

Write these down now, because every one of them will be proposed later by someone reasonable:

- ❌ **Leaderboards of devotion.** Ranking human beings by piety.
- ❌ **Streak freezes** — earned, purchased, or otherwise. Making grace a resource is worse than having no grace.
- ❌ **"Your devotion score."** A number that claims to measure someone's faith.
- ❌ **9pm push nags.** "Murugan is waiting for you."
- ❌ **Daily login rewards** with no practice attached — rewarding app-opening rather than reading.
- ❌ **Badges for opening the app**, changing settings, or other non-practice actions.
- ❌ **Sharing stats by default.** Share the verse. Never the score.
- ❌ **Gating meanings** — or anything else — behind progress.
- ❌ **Paid tiers, ads, or "supporter" cosmetics.** The charter says free. Free means free.

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11. Design-system alignment

Checked against `docs/color-guide.md`, `lib/theme/app_theme.dart` and the shipped v1.3.0 UI. Most of this plan drops into the existing system cleanly; these are the constraints it must respect, and two places where the obvious implementation would break something.

The palette already suits this

The forest-green depth scale (`background #D8EFD3` → `container #CAE8BD` → `card #B3D8A8` → `accent #80AF81`) maps directly onto progress surfaces:

Element	Token	Why
Daily card background	`container`	Sits one step above the scaffold — reads as a distinct object without shouting
Progress track (unfilled)	`card`	The corpus you haven't read yet
Progress fill	`accent`	The standard interactive/primary colour
Count numerals, milestones	`textHigh`	Already the emphasis colour
Dates, "n / 1334" labels	`textMuted`	Theme-invariant, correct in both modes
Locked / un-visited abode panel	`card` @ reduced opacity	Depth, not a different hue

The palette is a calm green, not an arcade palette. It **cannot** render a confetti-and-fireworks reward moment convincingly — and that is a feature, because §3 calls for quiet acknowledgment. The design system and the ethics point the same direction here.

⚠️ Rule 4: red is reserved

`color-guide.md` rule 4 — "*Red is reserved for destructive/error states only — do not use it decoratively.*" Conventional streak UI is built almost entirely from red and orange: flame icons, broken-streak warnings, urgency badges. **None of that is available to us**, and it happens to enforce guardrail 2 (never shame a missed day) at the design-system level. A broken continuity count renders in `textMuted`, never in red. If a mock-up needs red to work, the mock-up is wrong.

⚠️ `dynamic_color` breaks hardcoded collection colours

The app ships `dynamic_color: ^1.8.1` — Material You palettes derived from the user's wallpaper. The obvious Arupadai Veedu design (six panels, six hand-picked signature colours per abode) would clash badly under a user-derived palette. **Constraint:** the six abodes must be differentiated by *iconography, imagery and typography*, with surfaces derived from the active `ColorScheme` — never by six hardcoded hues. Same rule for milestone badges.

Other constraints

- **Never hardcode `Color(0xFF...)` in new widgets** (rule 1). Anything new goes through `AppColors` and `AppColorExtension`, with a paired light/dark value (rule 2).
- **Respect the lyrics font-size setting.** v1.3.0 shipped `LyricsFontSizeProvider`. The daily verse card renders song content, so it must honour that provider — a fixed-size verse card would silently undo an accessibility feature we just shipped.
- **Respect both language providers.** The daily card shows song content, so it follows `LyricsLanguageProvider`; its own chrome and labels follow `LanguageProvider`. These are independent settings and the card is the first surface where both appear together.
- **Material 3 primitives only.** Everything proposed here is a `Card`, `LinearProgressIndicator`, `CircularProgressIndicator`, `Chip`, `ListTile` or `Badge`. No custom-painted game UI, no third-party animation dependency.
- **Dark mode is not an afterthought.** Every progress and collection surface needs its `d`-prefixed counterpart from day one (rule 2). Devotional reading happens early morning and late evening — dark mode is a primary mode for this audience, not a preference.

Implementation caution: the dwell timer

The 90-second completion rule (§3) must be driven by a foreground timer bound to `WidgetsBindingObserver`, pausing on `AppLifecycleState.paused`. A naive `Timer.periodic` would credit a song while the phone sits locked in a pocket — which breaks the integrity rule that makes the count worth having in the first place.

Appendix — Octalysis reference

The framework (Yu-kai Chou) arranges 8 Core Drives on an octagon:

- **Top = White Hat** (1 Epic Meaning, 2 Accomplishment, 3 Empowerment) — makes people feel powerful, fulfilled and satisfied. Long-term, but lacks urgency.
- **Bottom = Black Hat** (6 Scarcity, 7 Unpredictability, 8 Loss) — creates urgency and obsession. Effective, but leaves people feeling bad. **Used sparingly here, by design.**
- **Right = Right Brain / intrinsic** (3 Empowerment, 5 Social, 7 Curiosity) — creativity, relatedness, curiosity. Rewarding in itself.
- **Left = Left Brain / extrinsic** (2 Accomplishment, 4 Ownership, 6 Scarcity) — logic, calculation, possession. Needs an external goal.

A design that leans Black Hat produces high short-term engagement and long-term resentment. For an app whose purpose is to support devotional practice, that trade is not available to us.

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